

TECHNOVA SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.

IT SECURITY & CYBERSECURITY GUIDE

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Department: Information Security

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Chapter 1: Introduction to Information Security

Information security protects organizational information assets against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, and destruction. Every employee shares responsibility for maintaining a secure environment within TechNova. Security measures are designed to preserve the trust of our clients and the integrity of our data. We must remain vigilant against evolving digital threats that target our infrastructure. Proactive defense mechanisms are essential to prevent data breaches that could harm our reputation. Training and awareness are the first lines of defense for every department. Management supports these initiatives to ensure a resilient operational framework. Together, we build a culture where security is integrated into every business process.

Chapter 2: CIA Triad

Confidentiality ensures only authorized users access information, preventing sensitive data leaks. Integrity ensures information remains accurate and complete throughout its entire lifecycle. Availability ensures systems and data remain accessible whenever they are required for business operations. These three pillars form the foundation of our entire IT security strategy. Without confidentiality, our trade secrets and personal data could be exposed to competitors. Maintaining integrity prevents unauthorized alterations that could lead to incorrect business decisions. High availability minimizes downtime and keeps the company productive during critical hours. Balancing these three elements is necessary to provide a robust and secure digital environment.

Chapter 3: Password Policy

Passwords must contain at least 12 characters to provide a strong defense against brute-force attacks. Your password selection must include uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols. Password sharing is strictly prohibited among employees to maintain individual accountability. You should never write down your passwords or store them in unsecured physical locations.

Using unique passwords for different accounts helps contain the damage if one is compromised. If you suspect your password has been stolen, you must change it immediately. The system may prompt you for periodic updates to ensure your credentials remain fresh. Following these guidelines is the simplest way to protect your digital identity at TechNova.

Chapter 4: Multi-Factor Authentication

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all remote access and cloud services used by staff. This requirement also extends to all privileged accounts with administrative access to systems. MFA adds an extra layer of protection by requiring a second form of verification during login. This second factor might be a code sent to your mobile device or a biometric scan. Even if an attacker steals your password, they cannot gain entry without the second factor. Always keep your MFA devices close and secure to prevent unauthorized usage. Contact the IT department if you experience any issues with your authentication tokens. Implementing MFA is a critical step in securing our most sensitive organizational resources.

Chapter 5: Email Security

Email is a primary vector for cyber threats, so users must exercise extreme caution. Do not open suspicious attachments, as they may contain hidden malware or viruses. Clicking unknown links in emails can lead to fraudulent websites designed to steal credentials. Always report phishing emails immediately to the security team for investigation. Verify the sender's email address to ensure it matches the name displayed in the message. Be wary of urgent requests that demand immediate action regarding financial or personal data. The company uses filters to block threats, but some may still reach your inbox. Your diligence in handling email is vital to keeping the entire network safe.

Chapter 6: Phishing & Social Engineering

Attackers may impersonate trusted individuals, such as managers or IT staff, to gain information. These social engineering tactics exploit human psychology rather than technical vulnerabilities. Always verify requests for sensitive information through an alternative communication channel. If a request seems unusual or unexpected, do not hesitate to ask for official confirmation. Be careful about sharing internal company details on social media or public forums. Social engineers often do extensive research to make their fraudulent requests seem legitimate. Training sessions are provided to help you recognize the signs of a social engineering attempt. Staying skeptical is your best defense against these manipulative digital and physical attacks.

Chapter 7: Internet Usage Policy

Internet access provided by the company is intended primarily for legitimate business purposes. Illegal or inappropriate browsing on company networks is strictly prohibited at all times. Users should avoid websites that are known to host malicious software or pirated content. The company reserves the right to monitor internet traffic to ensure policy compliance. Excessive personal use of the internet can slow down the network for other employees. Downloading large, non-work-related files is discouraged as it consumes valuable bandwidth. Be mindful of the content you access, as it reflects the professional standards of TechNova. Responsible internet usage helps protect our systems from external web-based threats.

Chapter 8: Remote Work Security

Employees working remotely must use company-approved devices to ensure consistent security. It is mandatory to use the corporate VPN for any connection to internal resources. Ensure your home Wi-Fi is secure by using a strong password and modern encryption. Avoid using public Wi-Fi networks in cafes or airports for accessing sensitive company data. Keep your workspace private to prevent

unauthorized individuals from viewing your screen. Remote work security policies are in place to extend office protections to any location. Report any lost or stolen remote equipment to the IT department immediately. Secure habits outside the office are just as important as those practiced on-site.

Chapter 9: VPN Policy

The VPN must be connected before accessing internal company resources from outside the office. This encrypted tunnel protects your data from being intercepted while traveling over the internet. Only use the VPN client provided and configured by the TechNova IT department. Ensure your VPN session is disconnected when you are no longer accessing internal systems. Using a VPN is a critical requirement for maintaining the confidentiality of our internal data. It serves as a secure gateway that verifies your identity before granting network access. If you experience connection drops or errors, contact the IT helpdesk for assistance. Reliable VPN usage is essential for the security of our distributed workforce.

Chapter 10: Laptop Security

All company laptops must have the screen lock feature enabled after a period of inactivity. Encryption is mandatory for the hard drive to protect data in case the laptop is stolen. Antivirus software must be active and updated regularly to detect the latest digital threats. Install software updates and patches promptly to fix known security vulnerabilities. Physical security of the laptop is also required, especially when traveling or in public. Do not leave your laptop unattended in a vehicle or in an unsecured common area. Use a privacy screen if you frequently work in environments where others might see your data. Keeping your hardware secure is the first step in protecting the information it contains.

Chapter 11: Mobile Device Security

Company mobile devices must use biometric authentication, such as a fingerprint or face scan. If biometrics are unavailable, a strong and complex PIN must be used to secure the device. Mobile devices should only have approved applications installed from official app stores. Remote wipe capabilities must be enabled so data can be erased if the device is lost. Avoid connecting to unencrypted Bluetooth devices that could compromise your information. Keep the mobile operating system updated to the latest version for improved security. Be cautious of permissions requested by apps that seem excessive for their function. Mobile security ensures that our productivity tools do not become liabilities.

Chapter 12: USB Device Policy

Only approved and encrypted USB devices may be connected to any company system. Unapproved USB drives often carry malware that can infect the entire corporate network. If you find a lost USB drive, do not plug it into your computer to see what is on it. Turn in any found devices to the IT department for safe inspection and disposal. Using personal USB sticks for business data is a violation of our security policy. Data transfers should ideally occur through secure cloud storage rather than physical media. Encryption on USB devices ensures that the data remains unreadable if the drive is lost. Adhering to this policy significantly reduces the risk of data loss and malware entry.

Chapter 13: Software Installation Policy

You should install only software that has been officially approved by the IT department. Unauthorized software can introduce security flaws or conflict with essential business applications. If you require new software for your role, submit a formal request through the proper channels. Software from untrusted sources may contain spyware or hidden tracking mechanisms. Licensed software ensures that the company remains compliant with legal requirements. The IT team will regularly audit installed applications to ensure policy adherence. Do not attempt to bypass

security controls to install restricted programs on your machine. Following these rules helps maintain a stable and secure computing environment for all.

Chapter 14: Cloud Security

Company information should be stored only in approved cloud platforms provided by the firm. Avoid using personal cloud storage accounts for any business-related files or data. Ensure that permissions on shared cloud documents are set to the minimum necessary access. Be aware that data stored in the cloud is still subject to our classification policies. Use strong authentication methods when accessing these platforms from various devices. The IT department monitors cloud usage to prevent unauthorized data exfiltration. Cloud services offer great flexibility but require careful management to remain secure. Protecting our cloud-based assets is a shared responsibility between the user and IT.

Chapter 15: Data Classification

Classify information as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted before sharing it with others. Public data can be shared freely, while Internal data is meant for employee eyes only. Confidential information requires strict controls and should only be shared with specific teams. Restricted data is the most sensitive and requires management approval for any access. Proper labeling helps everyone understand how to handle and protect specific documents. Ensure that physical documents also reflect these classification levels when necessary. Misclassifying data can lead to accidental exposure of sensitive company or client secrets. Understanding these categories is essential for maintaining our overall data integrity.

Chapter 16: Incident Reporting

Report suspected security incidents immediately to ensure a rapid and effective response. You can reach out through the IT Helpdesk or directly to the Security Team. Suspected incidents include lost devices, weird system behavior, or potential

data breaches. Do not attempt to investigate the incident yourself, as this may destroy digital evidence. Timely reporting helps the security team contain the threat before it spreads further. Provide as much detail as possible, such as what happened and when it occurred. Your quick action can save the company from significant financial and reputational damage. We encourage a transparent environment where reporting is seen as a positive action.

Chapter 17: Ransomware Awareness

If you suspect a ransomware attack, never pay the ransom or attempt self-recovery. Immediately disconnect the affected device from the network to prevent the spread of encryption. Contact the IT department at once so they can begin the incident response protocol. Ransomware often enters systems through malicious email attachments or unpatched software. Paying attackers does not guarantee that your files will be successfully returned or decrypted. Our backup systems are designed to recover data without interacting with cybercriminals. Stay informed about the latest ransomware trends by attending company security briefings. Awareness and quick disconnection are your primary roles in stopping ransomware.

Chapter 18: Physical Security

Always wear your ID badges visibly while you are on company premises. Prevent unauthorized access to secure areas by not allowing people to "tailgate" behind you. Be aware of visitors and ensure they are escorted by an authorized employee at all times. Report any suspicious individuals or unattended bags to the security staff immediately. Secure doors and windows when leaving a room or the building at the end of the day. Sensitive areas like server rooms have additional access controls that must be respected. Physical security is the first barrier against theft and unauthorized system access. Vigilance in the physical world is just as critical as vigilance in the digital world.

Chapter 19: Clean Desk Policy

Remove all confidential documents from your desk before leaving the workplace each day. This policy ensures that sensitive information is not visible to unauthorized passersby. Store paper files in locked cabinets or drawers when they are not actively being used. Clear your whiteboard of any sensitive project details after meetings have concluded. A clean desk also projects a professional image to clients and visitors in the office. Check for USB drives, ID cards, or keys that might have been left on your workstation. Following this policy helps prevent internal data leaks and physical document theft. Small habits like tidying your desk contribute significantly to our broader security posture.

Chapter 20: Business Continuity

Critical systems are protected through regular backups to ensure data can be restored. Disaster recovery planning is in place to help the company survive major system failures. Continuity procedures provide a roadmap for maintaining operations during unexpected events. These strategies are tested regularly to ensure they work effectively when needed. Every department has a role to play in the broader business continuity framework. Understanding your specific responsibilities during an emergency is vital for recovery. Resilience is built into our infrastructure to minimize the impact of any disruption. Our goal is to ensure that TechNova remains operational under any circumstances.

Chapter 21: Security FAQ

The Security FAQ covers common topics such as how to perform password resets. It also provides guidance on obtaining VPN access for your remote work needs. Procedures for reporting phishing and other suspicious activities are detailed here. If you need a device replacement, the FAQ explains the necessary steps to take. This resource is designed to provide quick answers to your most frequent security

questions. Check the FAQ section on the internal portal before reaching out to support. It is updated regularly to reflect new policies and common issues reported by staff. Having this information at your fingertips helps you resolve issues more efficiently.

Chapter 22: Security Contacts

For direct assistance, the Security Helpdesk can be reached at security@technova.com. You may also call the Security Team internally by dialing Extension 4001. General IT issues should be directed to the IT Helpdesk at itsupport@technova.com. The IT Helpdesk is also available by phone via Extension 2001. Save these contacts in your phone or directory for easy access during an incident. Support staff are available to help you with any security-related concerns or technical bugs. Prompt communication with these teams is essential for maintaining a secure network. Do not hesitate to reach out if you notice anything out of the ordinary.

Closing Note

Security is everyone's responsibility and requires active participation from all employees. Following these policies helps protect our customers, our colleagues, and company information. Your commitment to these standards ensures the long-term success of TechNova. We thank you for your cooperation in maintaining a safe and secure digital environment. As technology evolves, our policies will continue to adapt to meet new challenges. Review this guide periodically to stay current with our security expectations. Integrity in our security practices is a core value of our organizational culture. Together, we can defend against any threat and secure our digital future.